Section Overview

- Introduction to CUDA, SGEMM, and the Naive Kernel

What is GEMM?

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Example

During the forward pass when training a model, we accumulate the gradients from the entire batch.

What is GEMM?

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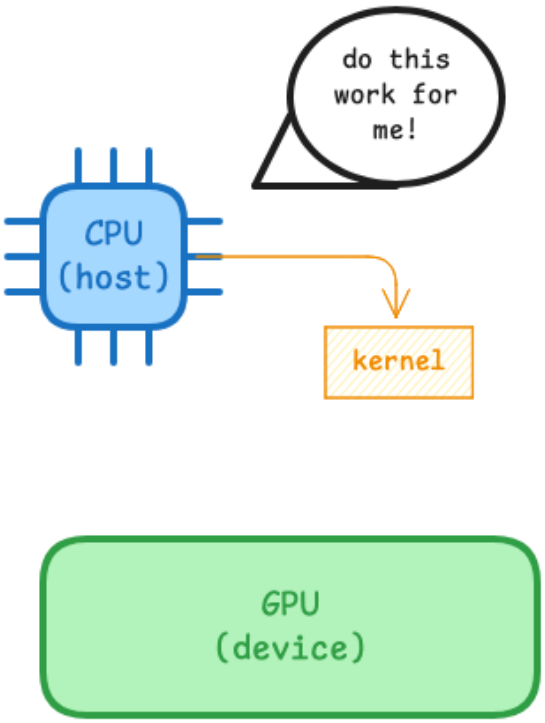
```
sgemm(
  int M, int N, int K,
  float alpha, float *A, float *B,
  float beta, float *C
)
```

$$\underbrace{A}_{M\times K} \quad \underbrace{B}_{K\times N} \quad \underbrace{C}_{M\times N}$$

- M: rows of A and C
- N: columns of B and C
- K: shared reduction dimension

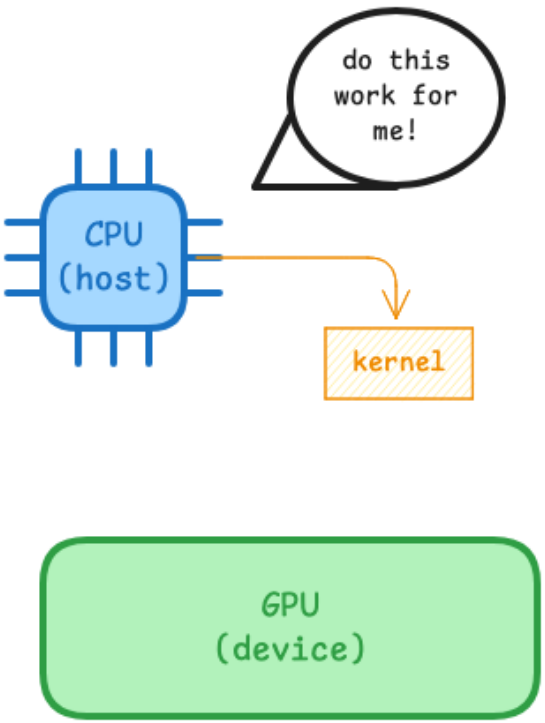
CUDA Basics (Host vs. Device)

- The CPU is known as the **host**, and manages top level logic.
- The GPU is known as the **device**, and does the heavy lifting.
- The host launches **kernels** to the device.



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- The CPU is known as the **host**, and manages top level logic.
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```
int main() {
  const int M = 128, N = 128, K = 128;

  float *dA, *dB, *dC;
  cudaMalloc(&dA, M * K * sizeof(float);
  cudaMalloc(&dB, K * N * sizeof(float));
  cudaMalloc(&dC, M * N * sizeof(float));

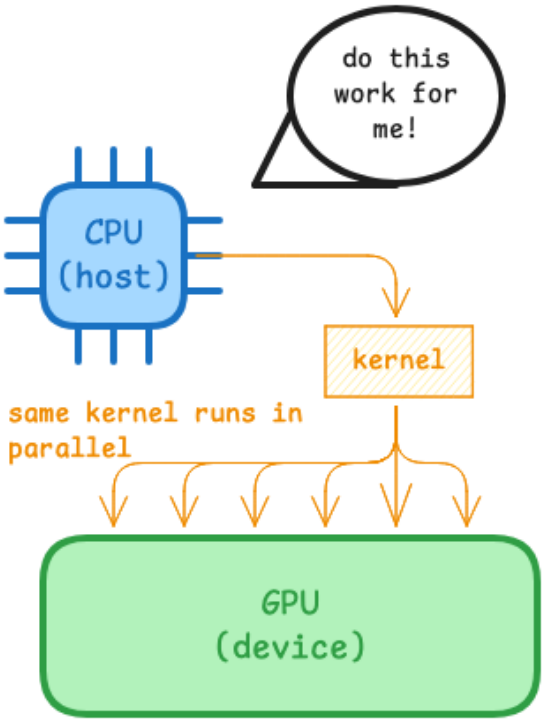
  // load values into these device pointers...

  run_sgemm_naive(M, N, K, 1, dA, dB, 0, dC);

  cudaFree(dA); cudaFree(dB); cudaFree(dC);
}
```

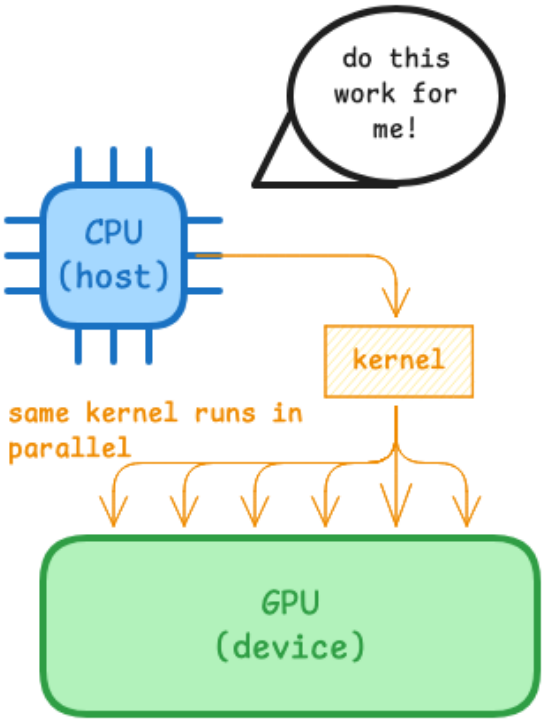
CUDA Basics (Kernel Execution)

- A kernel runs in parallel on many **threads** on the device.
- The number of threads the device allocates is configured by the host, when it **launches** the kernel.



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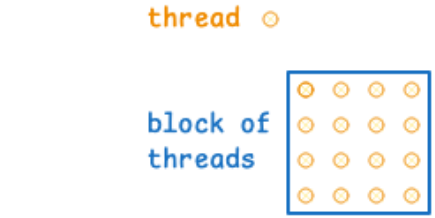



```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  // implementation hidden for now ...
}
```

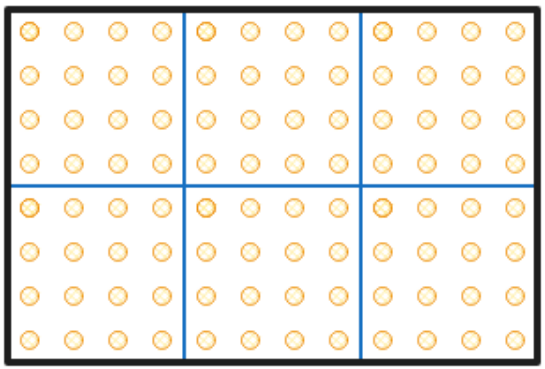
```
template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                        const float beta, float *C) {
  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
```

CUDA Basics (Threads, Blocks, Grids)

- Threads are grouped into **blocks**.
- The collection of blocks requested by the host is organized in a **grid**.



Grid of blocks



```cpp
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  // implementation hidden for now ...
}
```

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template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
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  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
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```

Why Threads, Blocks, Grids?

This seems complicated, why can't we just ask for N threads?

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Relation to hardware

This hierarchy is closely related to how the device schedules the execution. We will see later how to use this to optimize performance.

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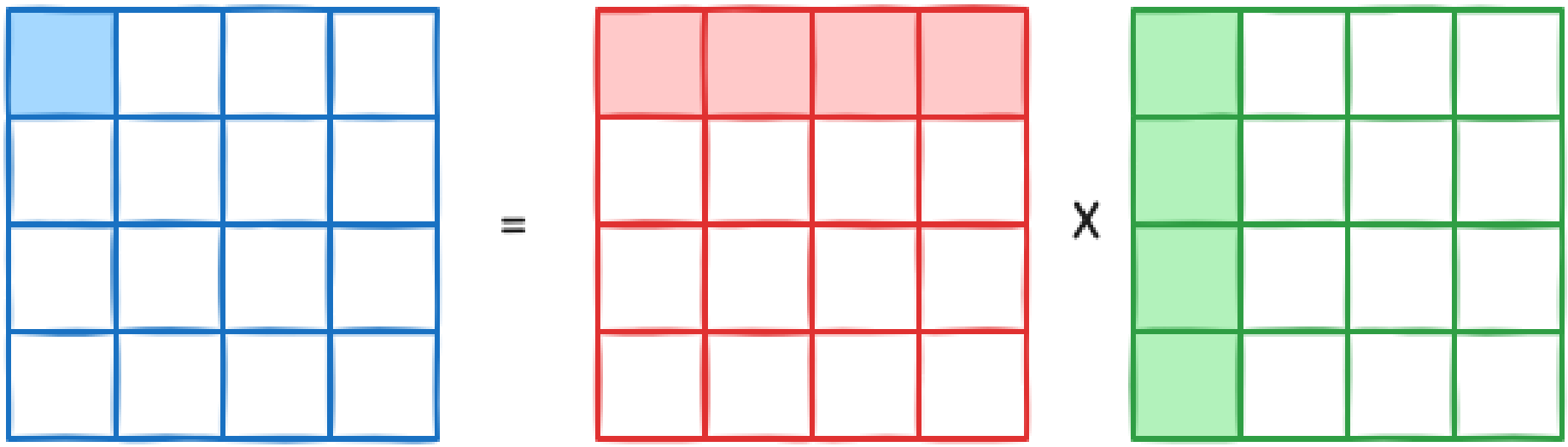
Thread, Block, Grid hierarchy

Threads are grouped into blocks of constant size/shape.
Blocks are launched as a grid.
We choose the dimensions of the grid to control how many blocks are launched, and thus how many threads are launched.

Let's design a SGEMM kernel!

Recall

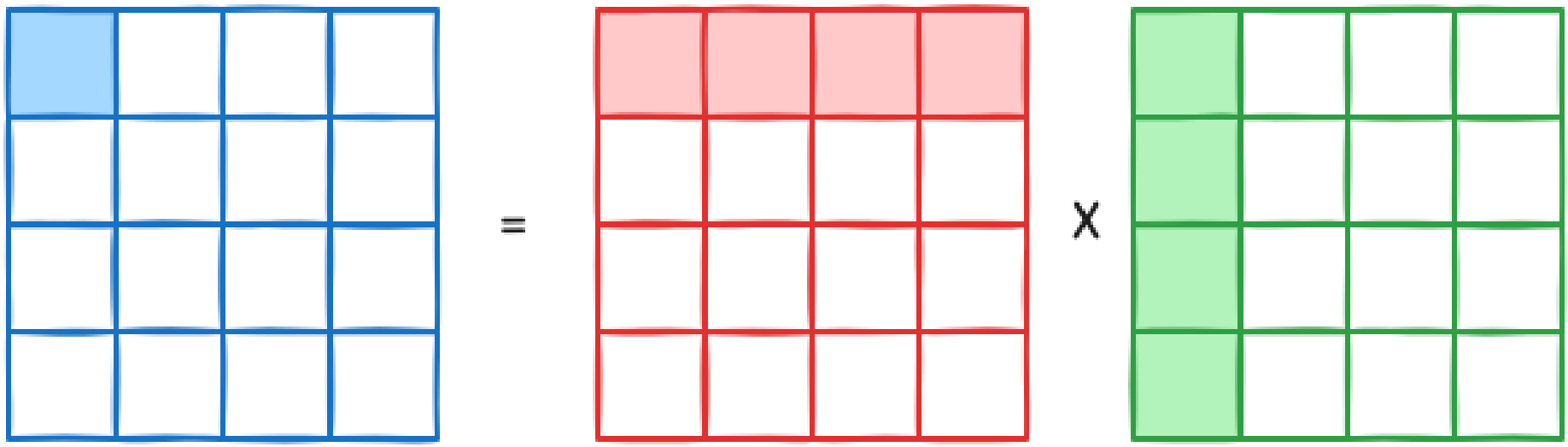
Recall that matrix multiplication is naturally parallel, and the output elements of C can be computed independently in parallel.



Let's design a SGEMM kernel!

Recall

Recall that matrix multiplication is naturally parallel, and the output elements of C can be computed independently in parallel.



We can naturally map one thread to each output element!

Naive kernel launch

Example (One thread per output element)

We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C.

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We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C. Let A have shape 5000×3000, and B have shape 3000×4000. Thus, C must have shape 5000×4000. $m = 5000$, $n = 4000$, $k = 3000$.

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Example (One thread per output element)

We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C. Let A have shape 5000×3000, and B have shape 3000×4000. Thus, C must have shape 5000×4000. $m = 5000$, $n = 4000$, $k = 3000$.

We want blocks of 32×32, so $BM, BN = 32$.

```
int M = 5000, N = 4000, K = 3000;
float alpha = 1, beta = 0;

float *dA, *dB, *dC; // Allocate buffers on the DEVICE.
cudaMalloc(&dA, M * K * sizeof(float);
cudaMalloc(&dB, K * N * sizeof(float));
cudaMalloc(&dC, M * N * sizeof(float));
// BM, BN are compile-time constants!
launch_sgemm_naive<32,32>(M, N, K, alpha, dA, dB, beta, dC);
```

Naive kernel launch

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We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C. Let A have shape 5000×3000, and B have shape 3000×4000. Thus, C must have shape 5000×4000. $m = 5000$, $n = 4000$, $k = 3000$.

We want blocks of 32×32, so $BM, BN = 32$.

```
launch_sgemm_naive<32,32>(M, N, K, alpha, dA, dB, beta, dC);
// inside launcher function
  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C)
```

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We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C. Let A have shape 5000×3000, and B have shape 3000×4000. Thus, C must have shape 5000×4000. $m = 5000$, $n = 4000$, $k = 3000$.

We want blocks of 32×32, so $BM, BN = 32$.

```
launch_sgemm_naive<32,32>(M, N, K, alpha, dA, dB, beta, dC);
// inside launcher function
  dim3 blockDim(32, 32);
  dim3 gridDim((4000 + 32 - 1) / 32, (5000 + 32 - 1) / 32); // Ceil division
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C)
```

Naive kernel launch

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We want to do a plain matrix multiplication between matrices A and B and store it into C. Let A have shape 5000×3000, and B have shape 3000×4000. Thus, C must have shape 5000×4000. $m = 5000$, $n = 4000$, $k = 3000$.

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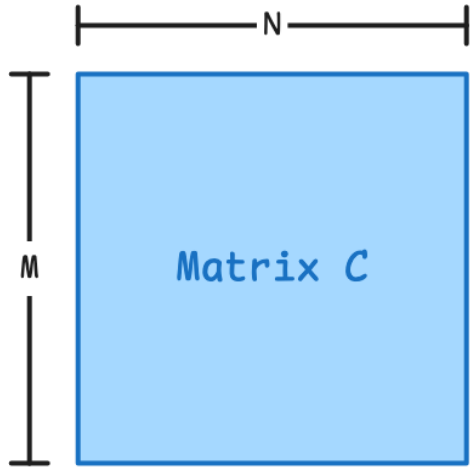
```
launch_sgemm_naive<32,32>(M, N, K, alpha, dA, dB, beta, dC);
// inside launcher function
  dim3 blockDim(32, 32);
  dim3 gridDim(126, 158); // Ceil division
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C)
```

Naive SGEMM Kernel

```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  const int y = blockIdx.y * blockDim.y + threadIdx.y;
  const int x = blockIdx.x * blockDim.x + threadIdx.x;

  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; i++) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
    }

    C[y * N + x] = alpha * sum + beta * C[y * N + x];
  }
}
template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                        const float beta, float *C) {
  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
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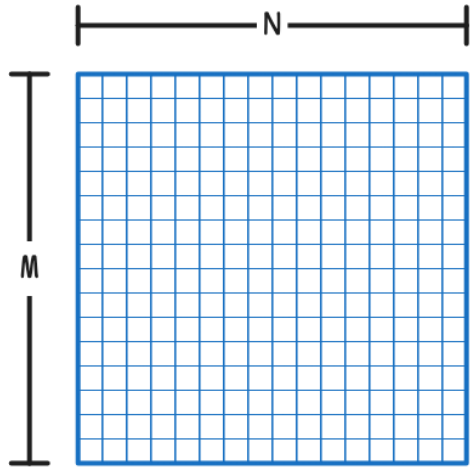


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  const int x = blockIdx.x * blockDim.x + threadIdx.x;

  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; i++) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
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template <int BM, int BN>
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}
```

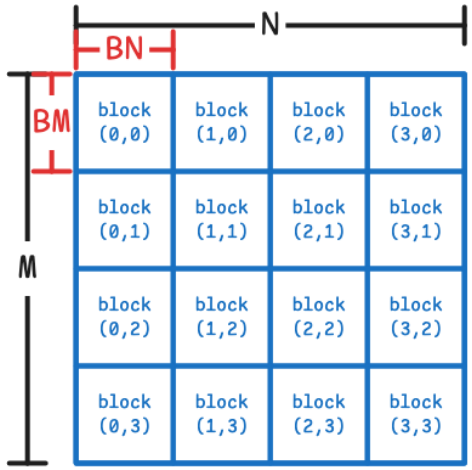


Naive SGEMM Kernel

```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  const int y = blockIdx.y * blockDim.y + threadIdx.y;
  const int x = blockIdx.x * blockDim.x + threadIdx.x;

  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; i++) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
    }

    C[y * N + x] = alpha * sum + beta * C[y * N + x];
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}
template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
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  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
```

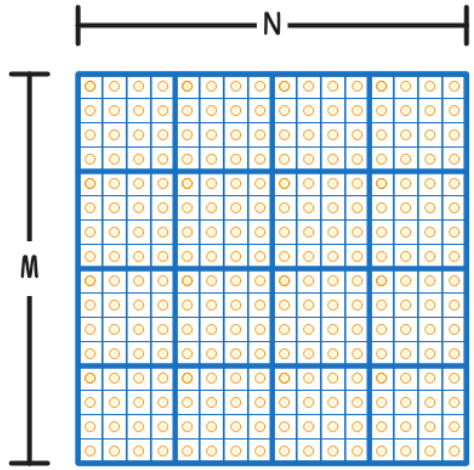


Naive SGEMM Kernel

```
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  const int y = blockIdx.y * blockDim.y + threadIdx.y;
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  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; i++) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
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template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                        const float beta, float *C) {
  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
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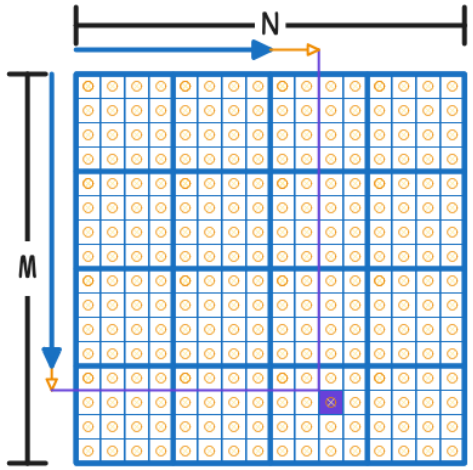


Naive SGEMM Kernel

```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  const int y = blockIdx.y * blockDim.y + threadIdx.y;
  const int x = blockIdx.x * blockDim.x + threadIdx.x;

  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; i++) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
    }

    C[y * N + x] = alpha * sum + beta * C[y * N + x];
  }
}
template <int BM, int BN>
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                        const float beta, float *C) {
  dim3 blockDim(BN, BM);
  dim3 gridDim((N + BN - 1) / BN, (M + BM - 1) / BM);
  sgemm_naive<<<gridDim, blockDim>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
```



Naive SGEMM visualization

- One thread computes one element of C.
- It walks one row of A and one column of B for the full dot product.

Play naive-kernel visualization

Naive CUDA is already faster than the CPU

